



EUROPEAN PARLIAMENT (EP)

Background Paper

Topic: Strengthening the European Union's Energy Security and Green Transition Amid Geopolitical Instability

Chair: _____

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I. The European Parliament (EP): History and Powers

The European Parliament (EP) is one of the main legislative institutions of the European Union (EU). Established in 1952 as the Common Assembly of the European Coal and Steel Community, it later evolved into the directly elected European Parliament in 1979.

Historical Background

The European Parliament was created to represent the citizens of EU Member States at the supranational level. Over time, its powers expanded significantly through successive EU treaties, including the Maastricht Treaty (1993), the Lisbon Treaty (2009), and others.

Today, the EP plays a central role in shaping EU legislation, approving the EU budget, and supervising other EU institutions such as the European Commission.

The Parliament has been particularly active in:

- Climate and environmental legislation
- Energy policy reform
- Economic stability measures
- External relations and security policy

Powers and Functions

The European Parliament has the authority to:

- Co-legislate with the Council of the European Union
- Amend and approve EU legislation
- Approve the EU budget
- Oversee the European Commission
- Influence EU external energy and climate policy

Although it does not directly control national energy policies, the EP significantly shapes EU-wide frameworks, regulations, and funding mechanisms.

II. Introduction to the Topic

Energy security has become a critical priority for the European Union, particularly in light of geopolitical instability, supply disruptions, and the ongoing transition toward renewable energy.

The EU seeks to reduce dependency on external energy suppliers while accelerating its Green Transition under the European Green Deal, aiming to achieve climate neutrality by 2050.

However, geopolitical tensions, fluctuating global energy markets, and infrastructure vulnerabilities pose challenges to both energy security and sustainability goals.

III. Historical and Strategic Background

Historically, the EU has relied heavily on energy imports, particularly natural gas and oil from external suppliers. Geopolitical conflicts and regional instability have exposed vulnerabilities in Europe's energy system.

In response, the EU has introduced key initiatives such as:

- The European Green Deal
- The Fit for 55 Package
- RE Power EU Plan
- Expansion of renewable energy targets

The green transition aims to increase renewable energy production, improve energy efficiency, and reduce greenhouse gas emissions. However, balancing short-term energy security with long-term climate goals remains complex.

IV. Economic and Political Impacts

Energy insecurity and transition challenges have significant implications:

1. Economic Stability

Energy price volatility affects households, industries, and inflation rates.

2. Strategic Autonomy

Reducing dependency on external suppliers strengthens EU geopolitical independence.

3. Industrial Competitiveness

The transition toward renewable technologies impacts manufacturing, innovation, and job markets.

4. Social Equity

Rising energy costs disproportionately affect low-income households.

5. Climate Commitments

Failure to meet transition targets risks undermining the EU's leadership in global climate action.

V. International and EU Framework

Relevant frameworks include:

- The European Green Deal
- The Paris Agreement
- The EU Climate Law
- REPowerEU
- The Energy Union Strategy

These frameworks aim to ensure secure, sustainable, competitive, and affordable energy across Member States.

However, implementation varies across countries, and political consensus is sometimes challenged by economic pressures and national interests.

VI. Current Situation (2026 Context)

As of 2026:

- The EU continues diversifying energy suppliers.
- Renewable energy capacity has expanded significantly.
- Energy prices remain sensitive to geopolitical tensions.
- Investments in hydrogen, wind, solar, and nuclear energy are increasing.

- Debates continue regarding energy sovereignty, nuclear power's role, and fossil fuel phase-outs.

Geopolitical instability continues to test the EU's resilience and unity in energy policymaking.

VII. Key Questions for Debate

Delegates should consider:

- How can the EU balance energy security with ambitious climate targets?
- Should nuclear energy play a greater role in the green transition?
- How can energy dependency on external suppliers be reduced sustainably?
- What policies can protect vulnerable populations from rising energy costs?
- How can EU Member States improve coordination in energy strategy?

VIII. Conclusion

Strengthening the European Union's energy security while advancing the green transition is one of the most pressing strategic challenges of the decade.

The European Parliament plays a key role in:

- Legislating climate and energy policies
- Promoting sustainable innovation
- Ensuring democratic oversight
- Strengthening EU strategic autonomy

Delegates must craft policies that enhance resilience, sustainability, and economic stability while preserving the EU's long-term climate commitments.